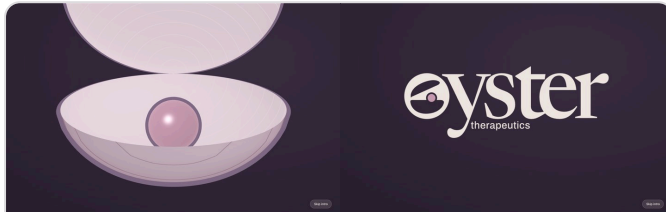


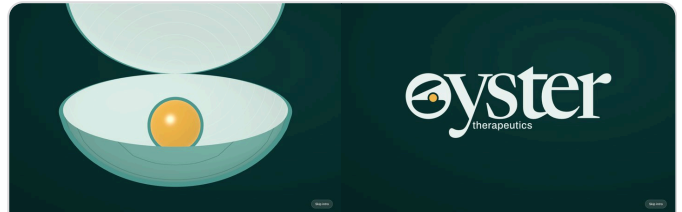
How we got to the four Oyster websites

A summary of the key discussions and decisions behind the Oyster website and logo, a map of how they led to four versions of the website (two logos, each in the Nacre and Tidepool palettes, each opened by a 3D intro), and the steps, tools and skills needed to rebuild them.



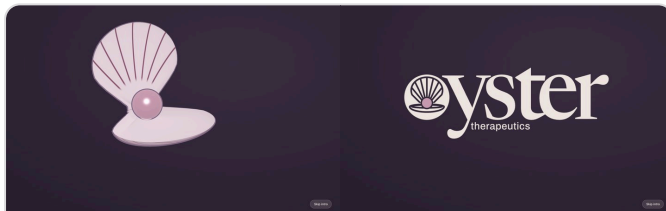
Old logo · Nacre

claude.ai/artifact/NTiBBienf6HvCseLhbCDHU
[oyster/intro/index.html](#)



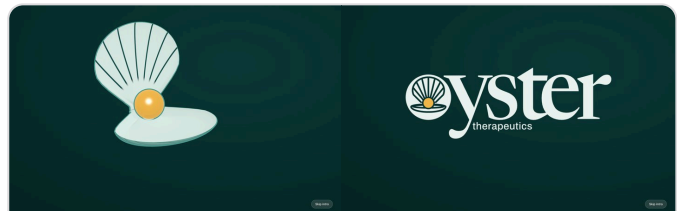
Old logo · Tidepool

claude.ai/artifact/QNC92GFvJXE6w1tULP5ELu
[oyster/intro/tidepool.html](#)



New logo · Nacre

claude.ai/artifact/7dgMtsG9wGQ18WXi8d6J73
[oyster/intro/fan-nacre.html](#)



New logo · Tidepool

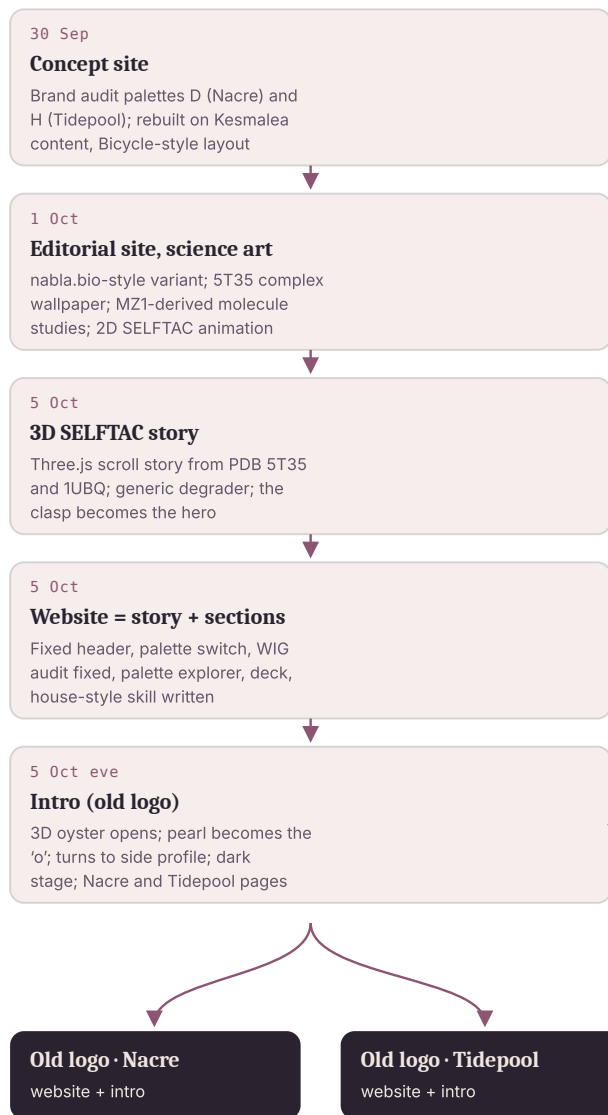
claude.ai/artifact/FdQsz8x3zDvkPnTZvowc1s
[oyster/intro/fan-tidepool.html](#)

Each site opens with its intro (left: the clam opening; right: the logotype it lands as), then the 3D SELFTAC scroll story and the company sections. All versions are linked from one page: [Oyster Site Versions](#). Links are private to the owner until shared from each page's Share menu.

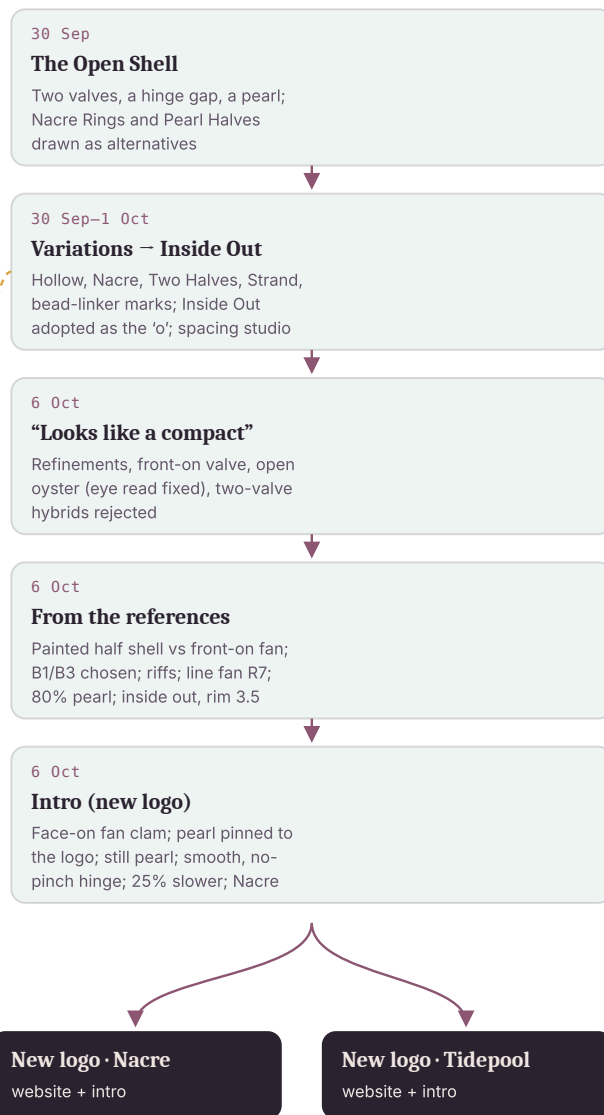
1. The map

Two strands of work ran side by side and met at the end: the website and its science story on the left, the logo on the right. The old logo's intro was built around Inside Out; the new logo needed its own intro, so the intro was rebuilt once the new mark was chosen.

WEBSITE AND STORY



LOGO



The dashed line: Inside Out, adopted on 1 October, is the logo the old intro lands in. Dates are the days the work was committed (Sept–Oct 2026), over four working days. Earlier days are reconstructed here from the repository's commit messages and the project's house-style notes; 6 October from the conversation itself.

2. Key discussions and decisions

Brand foundations

- **Two palettes, always both.** From a brand audit, option D (*Nacre*: pearl pinks, mauve ink) and option H (*Tidepool*: deep teal with gold) were chosen. Every page has a palette switch and every element is checked in both. Four further palettes were explored later (palette explorer) but not adopted.
- **Type:** Newsreader (headings and statements), Archivo (body and UI), IBM Plex Mono (small labels). The logotype is lowercase “oyster” drawn from Newsreader outlines with optically even spacing, set in a purpose-built Logotype studio, with “therapeutics” tucked under the tail of the y.
- **The clasp is the hero.** The reversible bond where the two halves of a SELFTAC degrader meet is the idea the company most wants seen. It appears as two gold (*Nacre*) or coral (*Tidepool*) pearls joined by a bond: on section labels, the story’s progress rail and the pipeline.

Website and science story

- **Content and layout.** The concept site was rebuilt on Kesmalea’s public story and a Bicycle-style structure (a giant wordmark that shrinks into the header, labelled statement sections); an editorial variant (after *nabla.bio*) followed. The current site makes the 3D story its landing page, followed by vision, why Oyster, pipeline, team, investors, news and contact.
- **Science illustration rules.** Proteins are smoothed real surfaces (BRD4 and VHL from PDB 5T35, ubiquitin from 1UBQ), credited on the page. The degrader must be *generic*: an early version traced from MZ1 was recognisable (JQ1, VH032), so the halves were replaced by invented ring systems, and the linker is drawn as a string of pearls.
- **Story pacing.** Seven beats (size problem, split, barrier, into the neuron, rebuilt, cleared, again), one continuous camera path, a visible “Skip to Oyster”, a portrait cut for phones, and reduced-motion support. The site passed a Web Interface Guidelines audit.
- **Working style.** “Change nothing else” means exactly that; renders are checked before success is claimed; existing pages are updated in place so links stay the same.

The first logo (old)

- **The Open Shell** (two valves, a hinge gap, a pearl) was chosen over *Nacre Rings* (read as a target) and *Pearl Halves* (read as a pill).
- Variations added a cradle for the pearl (*The Hollow*), bead-linker ideas from the molecule, and **Inside Out**: the shell cut out of a solid disc. *Inside Out* became the ‘o’ of the logotype, the favicon and the header, and the target of the first intro.

Rethinking the logo (6 October)

- **“It looks a bit like a makeup compact.”** The cause: a perfect disc, ruler-straight lips and a lid hinged open like a mirror. Refinements (bringing the clasp in, legibility, a favicon cut) and anti-compact fixes (rough edge, ruffled lips) kept the side view.
- **“A front-on, open clamshell.”** A straight front-on version read as an eye; a slight angle was allowed, giving open-oyster marks with depth. In one colour the pearl in an almond-shaped cup still read as an eye, fixed by moving the pearl onto the front lip.
- **The two references.** A painted half shell and a front-on fan with a big pearl. Blends of the two were rejected (“neither front-on nor half”); marks drawn closely from each followed. Note: a single half shell loses the two shells coming together (the SELFTAC story). **B1 and B3** (front-on fan, dish, big pearl) were chosen, with a caution that ribbed fans resemble a scallop and the Shell logo.

- **Riffs and the final mark.** Of eight riffs, **R7** (the fan as one even line) was taken forward; of five pearl sizes, **80%**; and an inside-out version with the drawing enlarged to fill the disc at three rim widths. The new logo is **11.7**: the line fan and 80% pearl inside out, rim 3.5.
- Every mark (59) is numbered by family in the [Oyster Mark Catalogue](#).

The intros

- **Old intro:** a 3D oyster rushes in, opens on its pearl, turns a quarter to side profile and lands exactly in the Inside Out 'o'; the word writes in and the logotype glides into the header. It plays on a dark stage and the lights come up as the logo lands.
- **New intro, for the face-on mark:** both valves take the fan's outline, hinged at the back; the lid lifts to stand upright as the fan, and the camera swings round to face it and drops to the mark's slight angle (10°) rather than turning side-on.
- **Refinements asked for, in order:** the pearl stuttered at the handover (it is now pinned to the logo's pearl to within half a pixel, and still while the logo fades in); it popped into being (now always there); it rolled back (now it never moves); the whole intro 25% slower; the closed shell's hinge looked pointed (now a smooth dome); and the hinge pinched in as it opened (now the closed and open shapes share the hinge's width). A full-size, still pearl does not fit a thin fan's hinge, so the closed clam is domed over it, checked numerically so the lid never passes through the pearl.

3. The logo journey

Selected marks from the catalogue, in the order they were drawn. Numbers are catalogue numbers; the live mark (4.1) and the new logo (11.7) are outlined.



1.1
The Open Shell
first mark, 30 Sep



2.1
The Hollow
cradle for the pearl



4.1
Inside Out
adopted; live mark



3.1
Bead Hinge
linker as hinge



4.3
The Clasp
clasp in the mark



4.8
Ruffled Lips
anti-compact fix



5.1
Front-on Valve
seen from above



6.3
Open Oyster
eye read fixed



7.3
Deep Cup
hybrid, rejected



8.1
Half Shell
the painting



9.1
Fan and Pearl B1
second reference



9.3
B3 Smooth
chosen with B1



9.5
Pearl Strands
riff



10.1
Line R7
chosen riff



10.3
Line, 80% pearl
favourite size



11.2
Inside Out Line
drawing small



11.7
Rim 3.5
new logo

The four websites, side by side

	Nacre	Tidepool	Without intro
Old logo (4.1, live)	Intro · Nacre	Intro · Tidepool	Website
New logo (11.7, proposed)	Intro · Nacre	Intro · Tidepool	Website

4. How to recreate it

Where everything is

Repository `ollieeee44/test`, branch `claude/sweet-keller-0aee5z` (which contains all earlier Oyster work), folder `oyster/`.

<code>oyster/landing/</code>	The 3D SELFTAC story: <code>build_meshes.py</code> (proteins and molecule from PDB 5T35 and 1UBQ) → <code>data/meshes.json</code> ; <code>landing_template.html</code> + <code>js/molecule.js</code> → <code>build_landing.py</code>
<code>oyster/site/</code>	The website: <code>build_site.py</code> joins the story with <code>sections.html</code> , <code>site.css</code> , <code>site.js</code> , <code>wallpaper.js</code> → <code>index.html</code>
<code>oyster/intro/</code>	Old intro: <code>build_intro.py</code> + <code>intro.js</code> → <code>index.html</code> (Nacre), <code>tidepool.html</code> . New intro: <code>build_fan.py</code> + <code>intro_fan.js</code> → <code>fan-nacre.html</code> , <code>fan-tidepool.html</code> , <code>fan-site.html</code>
<code>oyster/brand/</code>	Marks and sheets: <code>marks.py</code> (first marks), <code>refine.py</code> , <code>frontal.py</code> , <code>threequarter.py</code> , <code>hinged.py</code> , <code>refs.py</code> , <code>riffs.py</code> , <code>linepearl.py</code> (the new logo); each <code>build_*.py</code> makes a sheet; <code>build_catalogue.py</code> makes the catalogue; <code>logotype/</code> holds the spacing studio and <code>settings.json</code>
<code>oyster/deck/</code>	The PowerPoint Morph deck of the story (embedded 3D models)
<code>oyster/build_hub.py</code>	The Site Versions hub page; <code>report/</code> holds this report

Build order

```
cd oyster/landing && python build_meshes.py # only if geometry changes (rdkit, scikit-image, scipy)
python build_landing.py                    # the standalone story
cd ../site && python build_site.py           # the website (rebuild after any story change)
cd ../intro && python build_intro.py         # old-logo intros (index.html, tidepool.html)
python build_fan.py                        # new-logo intros and site
cd .. && python build_hub.py                 # the hub page
cd brand && python build_catalogue.py        # the mark catalogue (after any mark change)
```

How the new intro lines up with the logo

- `build_fan.py` swaps the new mark into every wordmark and exports the mark's geometry (fan outline, rib angles, hinge, pearl) into the script, so the 3D clam is built to the logo's measurements.
- At the end the camera faces the clam at 10° above, and its aim and distance are solved so the 3D pearl sits on the logo's pearl; the line-cut disc then fades in round it.
- Timings live in one table (`T`, scaled by `SLOW = 1.25`) in `intro_fan.js`; the closed shell's dome (`HW`, `CAP`, `PEAK`) was chosen with a clearance check so the lid never passes through the pearl.

Testing

Pages are checked in headless Chromium (Playwright), with the CDN copy of three.js 0.160.0 routed to a local npm copy (the sandbox cannot reach the CDN or Google Fonts). Every page that animates has a hook for frame-by-frame screenshots: `window.__story.frame(p)` for the story and `window.__intro.at(ms)` for the intros. Check desktop (1440×900) and phone (390×844), in both palettes, and look at the screenshots before reporting.

Publishing

Pages are published as Claude artifacts (claude.ai) and updated in place so links stay stable. The house-style skill's `references/pipelines.md` lists every page and its artifact link.

5. Skills, plugins and tools

Not standard with Claude Code (installed in the project, `.claude/skills/`)

oyster-house-style written for this project	The brand and build conventions: palettes, type, logotype, the clasp, science-illustration rules, how to work with the client, and where everything lives (<code>references/palette.md</code> , <code>references/pipelines.md</code>). Load it for any Oyster work; it is the most important file to share.
Taste skills <code>LeonxInx/taste-skill</code>	<code>design-taste-frontend</code> (and <code>v1</code>), <code>gpt-taste</code> , <code>high-end-visual-design</code> , <code>minimalist-ui</code> , <code>industrial-brutalist-ui</code> , <code>stitch-design-taste</code> , <code>redesign-existing-projects</code> , <code>full-output-enforcement</code> , <code>image-to-code</code> , <code>imagegen-frontend-web</code> , <code>imagegen-frontend-mobile</code> , <code>brandkit</code> . Installed at the start of the project to steer design quality; available to any session in this repository.
web-design-guidelines <code>vercel-labs/agent-skills</code>	Reviews UI code against the Web Interface Guidelines; used for the site's accessibility and interaction audit.
playwright-cli <code>@playwright/cli 0.1.22</code>	Drives a real browser to test and screenshot pages. A <code>SessionStart</code> hook (<code>.claude/hooks/session-start.sh</code> , registered in <code>.claude/settings.json</code>) installs it in Claude Code on the web.

Available in Claude, used here

- **Artifacts** (`claude.ai`): published pages; the Logotype studio uses an artifact database to save spacing settings for Claude to read back.
- **PDF and PowerPoint skills**: this report; the Morph deck (with `pptxgenjs`).

Libraries and tools

Python 3 with `fontTools` (logotype outlines and metrics), `RDKit`, `scikit-image` and `SciPy` (molecule and protein meshes), `Pillow`; `three.js 0.160.0` (3D, loaded from `jsDelivr`); `Playwright` with `Chromium` (testing and rendering); `Node.js`; `pptxgenjs` (deck); `LibreOffice` (deck previews). Fonts: `Newsreader`, `Archivo` and `IBM Plex Mono` from Google Fonts (the logotype is outlined, so it does not need them). Structures: `PDB 5T35` (Gadd et al., Nat. Chem. Biol. 2017) and `1UBQ`, downloaded from `RCSB`.

Appendix: every page

Site Versions hub	claude.ai/artifact/6TjGz7zGCkspdhHfUZicQa
Old logo: intro Nacre / Tidepool / website	claude.ai/artifact/NTiBBienf6HvCseLhbCDHU claude.ai/artifact/QNC92GFvJXE6w1tULP5ELu claude.ai/artifact/9pFqdk4otTS46U21phpLCK
New logo: intro Nacre / Tidepool / website	claude.ai/artifact/7dgMtsG9wGQ18WXi8d6J73 claude.ai/artifact/FdQsz8x3zDvkPnTZvowc1s claude.ai/artifact/NSRLa7dnMy96W1ViKGfjHc
Mark catalogue	claude.ai/artifact/AJUpcjMJuGVzcQt5ZAFnrK
Logo sheets, in order	Brand mark claude.ai/artifact/PKcMKiixVGjLF587ERBM69 Mark variations claude.ai/artifact/7nbPJzaNZTv9pXDPZftmnP Bead marks claude.ai/artifact/6ppVB3x6LGVpws36p4kHZh Inside Out, refined claude.ai/artifact/TYDiqpmFntUpWcALworY7g Beyond the compact claude.ai/artifact/H9Kr4y1ZRdNsRYhnCf1NKf Open oyster claude.ai/artifact/3XER9VkrQams9ryoFciMjb Open oyster picks claude.ai/artifact/JCZmPkn1P6zVMZuQHMMFY Two valves, one hinge claude.ai/artifact/N8uzWVpwns4Skux3XkmCYy From the references claude.ai/artifact/ACn2XP8bzFsQJVb5d5DKyb Fan and pearl riffs claude.ai/artifact/S2YScwuN6szkQzeQ2rex7Y Line fan, pearl sizes claude.ai/artifact/4zMWE6ipDqHpULNFiJG8os Line fan, inside out claude.ai/artifact/4gdAYgpeD5UJzm2T1zwqw1
Tools and other pages	Logotype studio claude.ai/artifact/7tNEfaWQeav7iTWnMSocu1 Palette explorer claude.ai/artifact/AfzgUFchFXjBXQWcboMYMy 3D story claude.ai/artifact/9aJKZGFD5fzeHUrQu9EPTk 3D model viewer claude.ai/artifact/7YaLDip9qnWoVVs9p7CVeh First main site claude.ai/artifact/WSV9dspDgvBBMTUiZZUEZN Editorial site claude.ai/artifact/12vnmPkAi83mVtPXtDLPZV